

TELLING TIME

Learn to read the clock
and talk about time in English!



3:00

For Level 3 • Age 8

Learning Goals

By the end of this lesson, students can...

1. Read a clock

Tell the time using the hour and minute hands.

2. Say the time

Use o'clock, half past, quarter past and quarter to.

3. Ask & answer

Ask: "What time is it?" and answer naturally.

4. Use daily routines

Connect time with school, meals, play and bedtime.

5. Practice

Listen, speak, read and choose the correct time.

Meet the Clock

A clock has 12 numbers and two main hands.



HOUR HAND

Short hand → tells the hour.

MINUTE HAND

Long hand → tells the minutes.

12

At 12 minutes = :00
(o'clock).

6

At 6 = :30 (half past).

Remember!

Short = hour. Long = minute. Read the hour first.

Two Ways to Tell Time

Analog Clock

A clock with hands.

Example:

🕒 7:00 → seven o'clock

🕒 4:30 → half past four

Digital Clock

A clock with numbers.

Example:

07:00 → seven o'clock

04:30 → half past four

Both clocks show the SAME time!

1. O'Clock (:00)

When the minute hand points to 12, we say “o’clock.”



1:00
one o'clock



5:00
five o'clock



8:00
eight o'clock



11:00
eleven o'clock

2. Quarter Past (:15)

15 minutes after the hour = a quarter past.



2:15

2:15 = a quarter past two

3:15 = a quarter past three

7:15 = a quarter past seven

“Quarter” means 15 minutes.

3. Half Past (:30)

30 minutes after the hour = half past.



4:30

4:30 = half past four

6:30 = half past six

9:30 = half past nine

“Half” here means 30 minutes.

4. Quarter To (:45)

45 minutes after the hour = 15 minutes before the next hour.



5:45

5:45 = a quarter to six

8:45 = a quarter to nine

10:45 = a quarter to eleven

Look at the NEXT hour!

5. Minutes Past

For 1–29 minutes, we can say “minutes past” the hour.



five past two



ten past seven



twenty past nine



twenty-five past three

Pattern

minutes + past + hour

6. Minutes To

For 31–59 minutes, we can say how many minutes remain to the next hour.



ten to three



five to eight



twenty to ten



twenty-five to four

Pattern

minutes + to + NEXT hour

The 60-Minute Clock

This is the most important pattern to remember.



:00

o'clock

:15

quarter past

:30

half past

:45

quarter to

:01–:29 / :31–:59

past / to

Asking About the Time

Question

What time is it?

Answer

It's three o'clock.
It's half past three.

Another Question

What time do you...?

Example

What time do you go to school?
I go to school at seven o'clock.

Using “At” with Time

AT + TIME

I wake up at 6:00.
I eat breakfast at 7:00.

AT + TIME

School starts at 7:30.
I go to bed at 9:00.

Remember

Use “at” before a specific clock time.

Telling Time in Daily Life

6:00

wake up

7:00

eat breakfast

7:30

go to school

12:00

eat lunch

4:00

play

9:00

go to bed

Quick Check!

Look at each clock and choose the correct answer.



- A. quarter past one
- B. quarter to one
- C. half past one



- A. half past five
- B. five o'clock
- C. quarter past five



- A. quarter past eight
- B. quarter to nine
- C. quarter to eight

Speaking Practice

Work with a partner.

Student A

Ask:
“What time is it?”

Student B

Look at the clock and answer:
“It’s ...”

Swap!

Now change roles.

Challenge

Ask: “What time do you go to school?” → “I go to school at ...”

Challenge: My Day

Write 5 activities from your day.

Write a time for each activity.

Say each sentence aloud.

Example: "I play at four o'clock."



4:00

Let's Review!

Can you remember these four key expressions?

o'clock

:00

quarter past

:15

half past

:30

quarter to

:45

You can tell time in English!

Great job! ☆

Exit Ticket

Before you finish, answer these 5 questions.

1. What time is 7:00? _____
2. What time is 3:30? _____
3. What time is 9:15? _____
4. What time is 5:45? _____
5. Ask your teacher: “What time is it?”

Teacher Answer Key

1. 7:00 = seven o'clock
2. 3:30 = half past three
3. 9:15 = a quarter past nine
4. 5:45 = a quarter to six
5. Expected: "It's ..." + a correct time.

Teacher Tips for an 8-Year-Old

Start Visual

Use a real analog clock or moveable clock hands.

Speak First

Let students hear and repeat before writing.

Use Routines

Connect time with school, meals, play and bedtime.

Mix Games

Use “Show me 4:30!” or clock races.

Correct Gently

Model the sentence again instead of over-correcting.

Level 3 Goal

Student can understand and say common times confidently.

TELLING TIME

Practice every day!
“What time is it?” — “It’s ...”

